

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

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Finding Reasoning Paths :

1 . **Un happiness ~ Bipolar disorder ~ Depression with mania /hypomania . **

2 . **Suicidal ideation ~ Major depressive disorder ~ Bipolar disorder . **

3 . **Feeling cursed ~ Psychosomatic symptoms ~ Bipolar disorder . **

4 . **Sleep disturbance ~ Bipolar disorder . **

5 . **Hopelessness ~ Major depressive disorder ~ Bipolar disorder . **

6 . **Decreased energy , concentration , and motivation ~ Major depressive disorder ~ Bipolar disorder . **

7 . **Suicidal ideation ~ Major depressive disorder ~ Bipolar disorder . **

8 . **Dissatisfaction with life ~ Psychosomatic illness ~ Bipolar disorder . **

Reasoning Process :

1 . **Key Symptoms Analysis : **

- The patient reports **un happiness , suicidal ideation , depression , restlessness , and energy depletion** over the past two weeks . These symptoms suggest a depressive episode , possibly with significant mood changes or energy fluctuations .

- Suicidal ideation and decreased energy /concentration are hallmark symptoms of **major depressive disorder (MDD)** .

- The mention of **disappointment , anger , frustration , hopelessness , guilt , and sadness** further supports a depressive diagnosis .

- However , the presence of **restlessness** and **amplified mood changes** raises the possibility of a manic or hypomanic episode , which are common in **bipolar disorder** .

2 . **Predisposing Factors : **

- The history of **feeling cursed and believing in fate** could indicate a preoccupation with catastrophic events or psychosomatic illness , which is commonly seen in **bipolar disorder** .

- The **global feeling of failing** and **exaggerated sadness** are consistent with depressive symptoms .

3 . **Differential Diagnosis : **

- **Major Depressive Disorder (MDD) : **

- Fits the clinical picture of depression , including sadness , energy depletion , and decreased motivation .

- However , MDD does not typically involve manic or hypomanic episodes or psychosomatic symptoms .

- **Bipolar Disorder : **

- Fits the clinical picture of a depressive episode with **restlessness , energy depletion , and psychosomatic symptoms** (e.g ., believing in fate) .

- Manic or hypomanic episodes could explain the restlessness and amplified mood changes .

- **Psychosomatic Illness : **

- Could explain the physical symptoms (e.g ., energy depletion , feeling tired) but does not account for the psychological distress or manic /hypomanic symptoms .

4 . **Integration of Symptoms : **

- The patient 's depressive symptoms align with MDD .

- However , the presence of manic /hypomanic symptoms (e.g ., restlessness , psychosomatic belief in fate) makes a diagnosis of **bipolar disorder** more likely .

- The depressive episode in bipolar disorder can sometimes be classified as **double depression** , where there are two episodes of major depressive disorder separated by periods of normal or only mildly elevated mood .

Conclusion :

The patient is likely to show **bipolar disorder** with **double depression** as one of his conditions .

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<answer>

The patient is at risk for double depression .

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